

Acer Aspire One
Is This The One?

Acer is yet another laptop manufacturer fired up with the Netbook craze. Acer calls their version the Aspire One. Like the MSI Wind and the higher-end ASUS EeePC, this one too runs on the all new power saving Intel Atom processor — the 1.6 GHz N270.

The Aspire One we received had a 120 GB hard drive, a three cell battery and a 9-inch screen. In terms of size, it is the smallest of all the Netbooks we've seen, but not by a lot. The weight too is similar to the three cell versions of the other laptops.

In terms of looks, it surpasses all the other netbooks. The body has a glossy finish and bits and pieces of contrasting colours are used on tips of the hinges.

Sporting a 1024 x 600 resolution, the One has a wider aspect ratio than the typical wide-screen desktop. The glossy finish on the screen means that a lot is reflected, but it also makes images look a little sharper.

The base slants into the front of the laptop, which makes it consume less space. The keyboard has no inclination whatsoever, and this makes resting the hands on the edge very difficult

One of the issues with the touchpad is the buttons for the mouse clicks. Both of them are situated vertically on either side of the touchpad which makes accessing it a little awkward. Fingers get crossed while trying to access the

button on the other end while using one finger to slide around the touchpad. The touchpad is also considerably smaller than the ones found on the other netbooks. Acer had to do this to make the laptop as compact as possible. Although there is a thick bezel surrounding the screen, there isn't any space spared around the keyboard. The keyboard feels alright, and the keys are sturdy. The keys do seem a little smaller than the 10-inch EeePC and MSI Wind. The Control key is on the extreme left of the key-



board unlike the MSI Wind where the Function key is the last key in that row. Acer could have tried to squeeze the bezel around the screen a little more, but that would mean making the keyboard even more cramped and tiny than it already is.

One cannot help but feel



that with such a large bezel, Acer might have put in a 10-inch screen instead; though this would raise costs. The speakers are weak, and

sound extremely flat. The sound is a lot better once you connect headphones to it.

The laptop doesn't have enough vents on the sides to throw out hot air, which means it runs warm most of the time. Expansion is taken care of by the three USB ports and two separate SD card readers on the laptop.

The Aspire One comes with a soft inner lined carry pouch and a very small power adaptor, which doesn't get very hot.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

ASUS's eRecovery feature comes installed which ensures you don't lose any drivers or software.

The Acer Aspire One comes in many flavours and the Linux version is easily the cheapest of all the Netbooks. At Rs 20,999, the one we reviewed — the 9-inch one with a 3-cell battery and a 120 GB hard drive makes excellent sense. Overall, this is an impressively put together Netbook, and is well worth the price tag.

Specifications:
Intel Atom N270 1.6 GHz, 1 GB RAM, 120 GB HDD, 8.9-inch LCD (1024 x 600), 10/100 LAN, 802.11b/g WLAN, 3-cell battery, Dimensions: 24.9 x 17 x 29 cm

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Web site: www.acer.co.in
Price: Rs 20,999

ASUS Eee PC 1000H
Not Just Another Netbook

The Eee PC 1000H impresses with its superior performance and its gorgeous looks altogether making it all the more perfect companion for the road warrior.

We've noticed a trend from ASUS with the Eee PC — they improve on the older versions of this mini laptop, but keep the older ones around.

The latest, and the largest of these netbooks is the Eee PC 1000H, which shares many of the same features of its predecessor the Eee PC 901 including a 1.6 GHz Intel Atom processor, a 1.3 megapixel webcam, 1GB of RAM and the same gorgeous drop dead looks. However, it has some differences like a larger 10-inch screen, more spacious keyboard, 160 GB hard disc drive and no more Linux — just plain old Windows XP; our favourite.

The Eee PC 1000H comes in different colours like

Red, Green, Pearl White, Fine Ebony, and all have the same glossy lid that's a fingerprint magnet. It's a good thing ASUS includes a complimentary cleaning cloth, because it's bound to be used often.

We got the Fine Ebony version for review, the glossy black lid has the new Eee PC logo in cursive on top. Its improved silver hinges give it a fashionable look.

The display, unlike the older 7-inch Eee PC, is a bigger 10 inches, with a native resolution of 1024 x 600. The display is quite bright and vibrant. The matte display screen looks good at various viewing angles. In comparison to the Acer One, the Eee PC's display seemed crisp and vivid, and it's something movie fanatics would love. The display controller is an onboard Intel GMA x3100, so don't get your hopes up about playing games or doing 3D intensive work.



The Glossy black bezel comprises of an inbuilt 1.3 megapixel webcam that is good for video conferencing, and the onboard Digital array microphones. The onboard speakers are Dolby Sound Room Certified, and despite being positioned underneath the laptop, they reproduce clear (but not powerful) sound. They're still good enough to cover a small room.

The Eee PC 1000H gets a bigger and better keyboard than its ancestors, the keyboard is about 92 per cent of the original Eee, will pose no problems for speedy typists and is comfortable to use.

The touchpad, however, is a bit of disappointment. Unlike the keyboard, it isn't comfortable to use, and the two click buttons are very hard on the fingers. The touchpad does support multi-touch, and the iPeople amongst you are sure to love it.

The heart of this Netbook is an Intel Atom N270 processor, running at 1.6 GHz. This processor, as you probably know, is designed for low-end computing, but it will not disappoint those looking to mainly work online and on some office documents. Overall, the Eee PC 1000H can handle most basic computing tasks easily with some mid-range tasks to boot.

The Eee PC 1000H comes with 1GB of RAM, for the Windows version and 2 GB for the Linux version — which is strange, because most Windows users would

prefer 2 GB of RAM. The disc drive is the biggest plus here — a whopping 160 GB. Although the drive is a slower 5400 rpm model, we were quite happy to not be running Windows Vista.

The Eee PC 1000H comes with a six cell battery. The battery lasted for 3hrs and 23 minutes under test conditions. The large battery and the power-saving Atom processor are to be thanked for the impressive battery life.

Despite the bigger screen and bigger battery, ASUS has tried to keep the weight as low as possible. At 1.45 kg, this Netbook shouldn't be hard to lug around.

Those looking for an extremely portable Netbook should definitely pay close attention to this latest model of the Eee PC. Now that the HDD is bigger, as is the screen, there's not much else once could ask for in a Netbook. However, you do have to consider the price, which is fast approaching the realm of full-fledged, entry level or mid-range notebooks. You may want to keep in mind that the Eee PC comes without an internal optical drive, as this might change your buying decisions.

Specifications
Intel Atom processor N270, 1GB Ram, 160 GB HDD, 10-inch display, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, LAN, Windows XP.

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Web site: www.asus.in
Price: Rs 26,490

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★